

Body weight

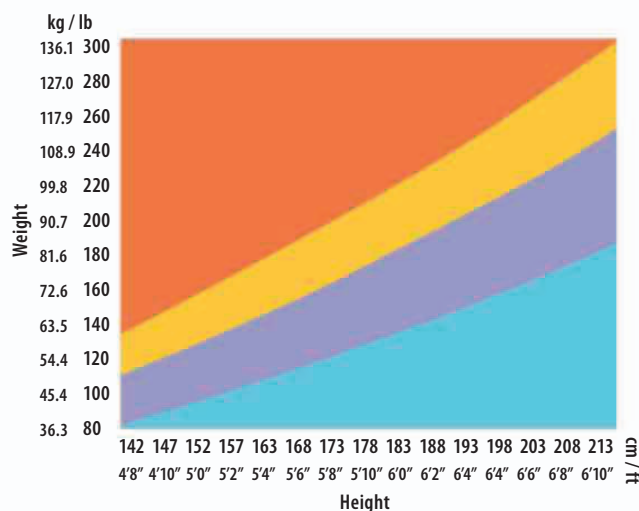
The human body is primed to survive long periods of starvation. When food is available, the body lays down stores of fat to fuel the body during the lean times. In developed countries, food is always available, so people may become overweight, taking in more food than their body uses each day. This can lead to a variety of illnesses.

Key



▷ Body mass index

This chart is used to work out the healthiness of a person's weight-to-height ratio. Being overweight causes problems for the body, especially the circulatory system. People who are underweight may have a weaker immune system.



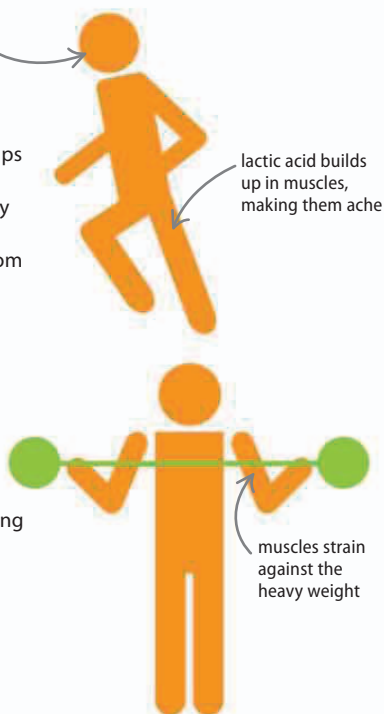
Exercise

The human body is built for walking long distances and having short bursts of activity. Modern working practices require people to sit still for long periods, so it is necessary these days to do regular exercise to keep the body in good condition. Exercise helps to burn the energy in food (measured in kilocalories, or calories for short), reducing weight gain due to overeating.

breathing increases to supply more oxygen

▷ Cardiovascular

Exercise that makes people out of breath helps strengthen the heart and keeps the circulatory system healthy. A fit person soon recovers from this exercise, known as cardiovascular exercise.



▷ Weight training

Lifting weights—including the weight of the body itself—strengthens muscles. The body feels stiff afterward as the muscles heal, growing back thicker than they were before.

Dangerous substances

Alcohol and tobacco products are sold legally to adults because they have a long history of use across the world, but they cause serious illness. Other substances—often just called drugs—are illegal, and cause many health and social problems.

▽ Threats

Misuse of alcohol, over-the-counter drugs, and smoking can lead to many health issues, both physical and mental. The main reason for this is addiction and dependency, which means the addict continues with the harmful behaviour and finds it hard to break away.

Activity	Associated health problems
tobacco smoking	cancer of lungs, mouth, esophagus, and pancreas; heart disease; lung problems, specifically emphysema, bronchitis, and scarring of lung tissue; addiction
alcohol use	physical damage to liver (cirrhosis); mental instability; poor judgment; dangerous behavior; increased risk of heart attack; inflammation of digestive tract and pancreas; addiction
drug use	mental and physical problems, depending on drug; severe addiction and dependency; risk of various cancers; addict may resort to crime to pay for drugs